

Employing in Norway

What You Need to Know · Employment Hero HeroForce EOR · July 2026

What does the EOR handle for you?

- **Employment contracts** — compliant written contracts under the Working Environment Act (Arbeidsmiljøloven)
- **Monthly payroll** — salary payments in NOK, itemised payslips and a-melding reporting to Skatteetaten
- **Tax withholding** — forskuddstrekk (withholding tax) and trygdeavgift remitted on your behalf
- **Arbeidsgiveravgift** — zone-based employer National Insurance contributions and mandatory occupational pension (OTP)
- **Leave and termination management** — notice periods, feriepenger (holiday pay) and dismissal-risk guidance

Employment Conditions

Contracts & Probation

A written employment contract is mandatory under the Working Environment Act, covering duties, location, hours, pay and notice terms. A probationary period (prøvetid) of up to 6 months may be agreed in writing, during which either party may terminate with 14 days' notice.

Item	Detail	Legal Basis
Written contract	Duties, location, hours, wages and termination terms — mandatory	Working Environment Act, Ch. 14
Fixed-term contracts	Generally require an objective justification; converts to permanent after continuous use beyond statutory limits	Working Environment Act §14-9
Probation period	Up to 6 months, 14 days' notice either side during probation	Working Environment Act §15-3
Dismissal consultation	Employer must discuss the dismissal with the employee before deciding, wherever practically possible	Working Environment Act §15-1

Working Hours & Overtime

Standard working hours are capped at 9 hours/day and 40 hours/week under the Working Environment Act. Overtime is permitted only in limited circumstances and carries a minimum statutory premium of 40%.

Rule	Detail	Authority
Standard hours	9 hrs/day, 40 hrs/week	Working Environment Act §10-4
Overtime cap	10 hrs/week, 25 hrs/4-week period, 200 hrs/year (extendable with union agreement)	Working Environment Act §10-6
Overtime premium	Minimum 40% above ordinary hourly pay	Working Environment Act §10-6(11)
Daily/weekly rest	11 hrs consecutive daily rest; 35 hrs consecutive weekly rest	Working Environment Act §10-8

Minimum Wage (2026)

Norway has no general statutory minimum wage. Legally binding minimum hourly rates instead apply in around nine sectors through "generally applied" collective agreements (allmenngjorte tariffavtaler) — including construction, cleaning, hospitality, electricians, agriculture and fish processing — ranging roughly from NOK 162 to NOK 260/hour depending on sector and skill level. Outside these sectors, pay is market-driven or set by ordinary collective agreements.

Sector (illustrative)	Typical Minimum Rate	Notes
Cleaning	~NOK 220-230/hour	Set via generally applied collective agreement
Construction (skilled)	~NOK 245-260/hour	Higher for skilled/experienced workers
Hospitality	~NOK 190-210/hour	Varies by role and experience

Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Entitlement	Who Pays	Key Condition
Annual Leave	25 working days/year (31 for employees 60+)	Employer, via feriepenger	Holiday pay (feriepenger) accrues at 10.2% of the prior year's earnings (12% for 60+), paid instead of ordinary salary during leave
Parental Leave	49 weeks at 100% pay or 59 weeks at 80% pay, shared between parents	NAV (National Insurance Scheme)	Includes maternal and paternal quotas reserved for each parent; unpaid leave available until child turns 3
Sick Pay	Employer pays 100% of salary to day 16; NAV thereafter	Employer (days 1-16), then NAV	Sickness benefit from NAV is capped at 6× the National Insurance base amount
Child's Sick Day Leave	10 days/year (15 with 2+ children); single parents 20-30 days	Employer, largely reclaimable from NAV	Requires 4+ weeks' employment; child under 12
Pregnancy-related leave	Voluntary leave before birth, plus 6 weeks' mandatory rest after birth	NAV via maternity benefit	Protected from dismissal during pregnancy and parental leave

★ HERO TIP

Feriepenger is one of the most common compliance traps for foreign employers in Norway — holiday pay is calculated on the previous calendar year's earnings and paid out (commonly in June) instead of ordinary salary during the holiday period, not on top of it. New hires without a full prior year of Norwegian earnings should have this clearly explained, as their first year's holiday pay will be lower than expected.

Payroll, Tax & Contributions

Employer Contributions (2026)

Contribution	Employer Rate	Notes
Arbeidsgiveravgift (employer National Insurance)	14.1% (Zone Ia/I — Oslo & most of Norway)	Zone-based: falls to as low as 0% in Zone V (Finnmark, parts of northern Troms); no upper salary cap
Mandatory Occupational Pension (OTP)	Minimum 2% of salary between 1G and 12G	Many collective agreements require 4–7%
Occupational Injury Insurance (Yrkesskadeforsikring)	Varies by insurer/industry	Mandatory, privately underwritten, not government-administered
Holiday pay accrual (feriepenger)	10.2% of gross annual earnings (12% for employees 60+)	Accrued cost, paid out the following year instead of ordinary salary during leave

Total Cost Example — USD \$3,000 Gross Monthly Salary

Cost Item	Amount (USD)	% of Gross
Gross salary	\$3,000.00	100%
Arbeidsgiveravgift (14.1%, Zone I)	\$423.00	14.10%
Mandatory occupational pension, OTP (2%)	\$60.00	2.00%
Feriepenger accrual (10.2%)	\$306.00	10.20%
EOR service fee (HeroForce)	\$600.00	20.00%
Estimated total monthly cost	~\$4,389.00	~146.3%

HeroForce EOR service fee shown at USD \$600 per employee per month, flat rate. Feriepenger is shown here as an accrual for illustrative purposes; in practice it substitutes for ordinary salary during the holiday period rather than adding to total annual pay. Employee deductions (withheld separately) include trygdeavgift (7.6% of gross income) and progressive income tax (fellesskatt + trinnskatt).

Income Tax (2026)

Norway applies a dual-base system: a flat 22% "fellesskatt" on ordinary income (after standard deductions), plus a progressive bracket tax (trinnskatt) on gross personal income, plus 7.6% trygdeavgift (National Insurance) on gross employment income. The combined top marginal rate on employment income is approximately 47%.

Trinnskatt Bracket (NOK, gross income)	Rate
Up to ~226,100	0%
226,101 – 318,300	1.7%
318,301 – 725,050	4.0%
725,051 – 980,100	13.7%
980,101 – 1,467,200	16.8%
Above 1,467,200	17.8%

Trinnskatt is layered on top of the flat 22% fellesskatt and 7.6% trygdeavgift — all three apply simultaneously to employment income within their respective bases.

Termination & Separation

Notice Periods (Working Environment Act §15-3)

Length of Service / Age	Notice Period	Key Rule
Probation (max 6 months)	14 days	Either party; must be agreed in writing
Under 5 years' service	1 month	Standard statutory default
5–9 years' service	2 months	Employer notice; runs from the 1st of the month after notice is given
10+ years' service	3 months (base)	Extends further if combined with age thresholds below
10+ years' service, employee aged 50–54	4 months	Working Environment Act §15-3(3)
10+ years' service, employee aged 55–59	5 months	Working Environment Act §15-3(3)
10+ years' service, employee aged 60+	6 months	Working Environment Act §15-3(3)
Employee resignation	1 month (never more than 3 months, regardless of	Working Environment Act §15-3(7)

agreement)

Severance Pay

Norway has no general statutory severance pay requirement. Where a dismissal is contested, employers often negotiate a severance payment so the employee accepts the notice and waives further claims, but this is a matter of negotiation rather than legal entitlement — collective agreements occasionally provide fixed severance schemes.

★ HERO TIP

Norway's Working Environment Act gives employees some of the strongest dismissal protections in Europe — a mandatory pre-dismissal consultation meeting is required wherever practically possible, and a successful unfair dismissal challenge can result in reinstatement plus back pay, not just compensation. Foreign employers should never assume home-jurisdiction termination practices apply; always route Norwegian terminations through your HeroForce EOR before any notice is issued.

Public Holidays 2026

Norway observes 12 public holidays (røde dager) in 2026, regulated under the Act Respecting Public Holidays and their Sanctity. Holidays falling on a weekend do not generate a substitute day off.

Date	Holiday	Type
1 January	New Year's Day (Nyttårsdag)	National
2 April	Maundy Thursday (Skjærtorsdag)	National
3 April	Good Friday (Langfredag)	National
5 April	Easter Sunday (1. Påskedag)	National
6 April	Easter Monday (2. Påskedag)	National
1 May	Labour Day (Arbeidernes dag)	National
14 May	Ascension Day (Kristi Himmelfartsdag)	National
17 May	Constitution Day (Grunnlovsdagen)	National
24 May	Whit Sunday (1. Pinsedag)	National
25 May	Whit Monday (2. Pinsedag)	National
25 December	Christmas Day (1. Juledag)	National
26 December	St. Stephen's Day (2. Juledag)	National

17 May, Constitution Day, is Norway's most significant national celebration and is a fixed date rather than tied to Easter. Working on a public holiday is regulated primarily by collective agreement rather than a fixed statutory premium.

Ready to hire in Norway?

HeroForce by Employment Hero is an Employer of Record solution that handles hiring, contracts, compliance and payroll across 180+ countries.

Onboard your first Norway employee in as little as one to two weeks — HeroForce EOR service fee: **USD \$600** per employee per month.